University of Basel

Swiss TPH
Swiss Tropical and Public Health Institute
Schweizerisches Tropen- und Public Health-Institut
Institut Tropical et de Santé Publique Suisse

Associated Institute of the University of Basel

Lesson 8: Writing Abstracts
Revising your manuscript

Our objectives for this lesson

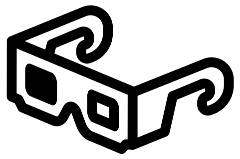
1. Examine the contents and form of some article Abstracts
2. Explore newer types of abstracts
3. Consider ways to revise your article/thesis
4. Consider some general writing tips
5. Focus on some language-related tips, issues and common mistakes

Please complete the course evaluation

- You have received an email with a link to the course evaluation.
- Please complete that now.
- Add personal comments to help me improve the course, so state what was helpful and what you think could make it better.

Abstracts

- Why do people write abstracts?
- Why are abstracts important?
- Have you come across abstracts that are different from ‘conventional’ research article abstracts?



You don’t get a second chance to make a good first impression!

Abstracts are essentially extremely concise summaries of the research study.

Conventional types of research abstracts

Conference abstract

- (usually) before publication
- Work in progress

→ Advertise your work

→ Get you a talk/poster

Research article abstract

- Publication
- Completed piece of work

→ Get your article published (editors) or read (databases)

- IMRaD, structured or unstructured
- Word limit (100-600 depending on guidelines)

Abstracts are decision-making tools for readers

Editors	Should they send the manuscript for review?
	Does it match the journal's interests?
Reviewers	Should they accept to review this manuscript?
	Do they have the required expertise?
Researchers	Should they read this article?
	Should they cite it?
Conference chairs	Should they invite this author for a poster /talk?
Funding bodies	Should they support this proposal?

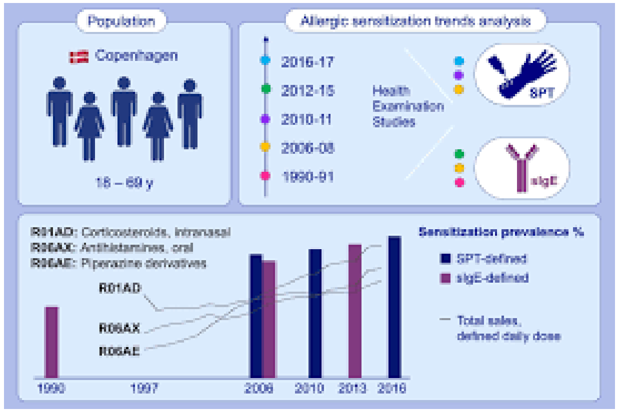
The abstract is potentially the only part of your article that is freely available.

Abstracts: requirements

- Check journal or departmental requirements regarding length, use of headings, keywords, etc.
- Subheadings similar to paper might be required: structured abstract. Advantages?
- Check other abstracts in field for trends
- Economy of expression and clarity are very important.

Task: Examine abstracts in your field

- Structured with subheadings?
- Length?
- Verb tense(s)?
- First-person pronouns?
- Newer forms of abstracts (e.g., author summaries or key points) included? Which? Length?
- Detail?
- Exact or approximated numbers in results?



Newer forms of abstracts: author summaries, video abstracts, key points and visual abstracts

Author summary

- As part of the move to improve accessibility of science, some journals, especially open access ones such as the **PLoS journals**, require an **author summary** in non-technical/non-expert language in addition to formal abstracts. https://journals.plos.org/ploscompbiol/s/submission-guidelines#loc-manuscript-organization

Video abstract

- Required by some journals such as Elsevier, BMJ, Cell. Writers briefly discuss and explain their papers in a short presentation. It should be within the conceptual scope of the article and directly support its conclusions. Note that **video abstracts** are subject to peer review. Examples: https://www.cell.com/video/video-abstracts
- The Language Centre of the University offers a course on making video abstracts.

Key points

- Some journals require a (bullet-pointed) list before the formal abstract, e.g. in *Nature* https://www.nature.com/articles/nri3384

Graphical/Visual abstracts in picture form

The main results/ conclusions are presented in a visual form (see visual on the right, and slides below).

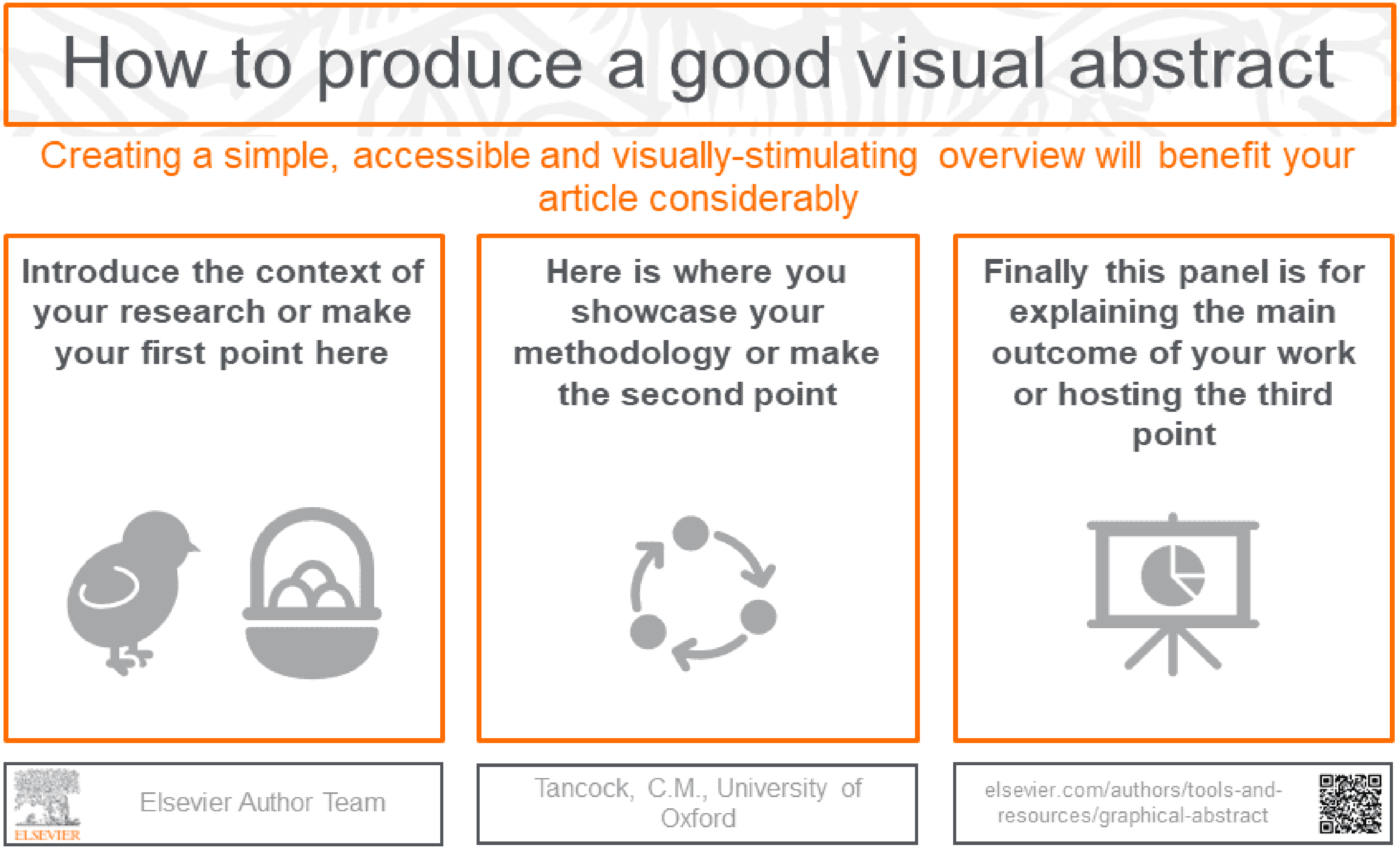
Journals might require several different types of abstracts for one article

This article in *Cell Host and Microbe* (published February 2023) has 4 types of abstracts:

1. An author summary called 'In brief'
2. A key-point summary (here called 'Highlights') with 4 bullet points of the main take-aways from the article
3. A traditional abstract (here called 'Summary')
4. A graphical/visual abstract

This article in the Elsevier journal *Cell Metabolism* (published April 2024) has three types of abstracts:

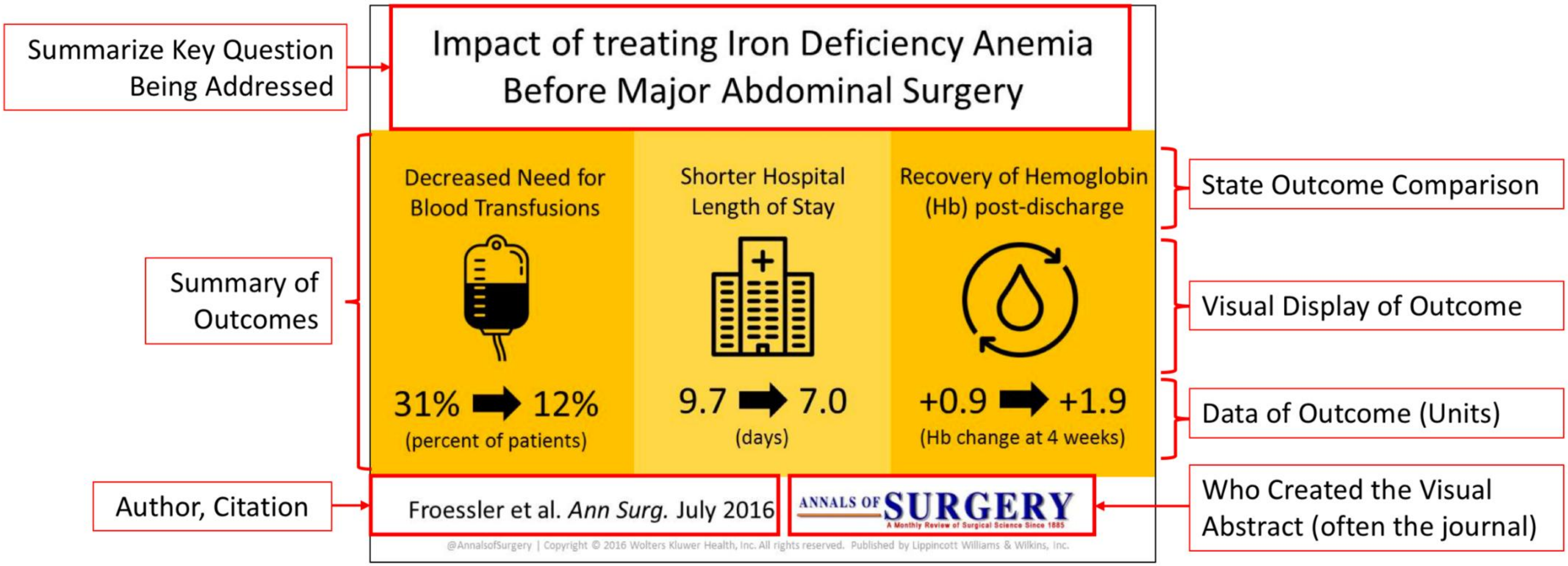
1. A key-point summary (here called 'Highlights') with 4 bullet points of the main take-aways from the article
2. A traditional abstract (here called 'Summary')
3. A graphical/visual abstract



https://www.elsevier.com/authors/tools-and-resources/visual-abstract

The graphical abstract will be displayed in online search result lists, the online contents list and the article on ScienceDirect, but will typically not appear in the article PDF file or print.

COMPONENTS OF AN EFFECTIVE VISUAL ABSTRACT



https://www.surgeryredesign.com/#visualabstract-section

Video abstracts and
'Thirteen ways to write an abstract'

Consult the BMJ Author Hub for information on producing video abstracts, including solutions for various budgets and examples of different types.

https://authors.bmj.com/writing-and-formatting/video-abstracts/solutions-for-different-budgets/

Read about 13 different kinds of abstracts!

- URL: http://www.mdpi.com/2304-6775/5/2/11
- DOI : https://doi.org/10.3390/publications5020011

General structure of ‘conventional’ research abstracts

Title	
Introduction	• Background • Gap • Research purpose / hypothesis / aims
Methodology	• Relevant information to address the research question / understand the results
Results	• Summary of main findings
Conclusion	• Implications of findings, impact, recommendations
Outlook	• Future or planned research

Abstracts: the writing process

Read guide for authors	Read the journal's 'Guide for authors' several times before you start writing the article and abstract.
Check length	Check abstract length required in 'Guide for authors'. If not stated, often 200-250 words.
State purpose and key argument or finding	Clearly state purpose of research and key argument or main finding. Use the right keywords for search purposes.
Mention approach/methods	Mention the approach/methodology of your research.
State implications without exaggeration	Use precise language for discussion and conclusion; state the implications of your findings without exaggerating them.
Represent value and refer to limitations	Represent a fair analysis of the value of your research after conferring with colleagues & supervisor. Refer to the limitations of the study.

Structure of abstracts: Commonly follows research article structure

Step 1 — Explain why the research was conducted (Give **background**, state the **research gap**.)

Step 2 — Describe what the **aims** were

(Outline the purpose/aims.)

Step 3 — Say how these **aims were met**.

(Describe how the gap was filled; refer to the methods.)

Step 4 — Describe what the **main findings** were.

(Summarize the main results of the research.)

Step 5 — Explain briefly what it all means

(Describe the **implications/ impact/conclusions**.)

Structured versus unstructured abstracts: example

Background

An accurate diagnosis of helminth infection is important to improve patient management. However, there is considerable intra- and inter-specimen variation of helminth egg counts in human feces. Homogenization of stool samples has been suggested to improve diagnostic accuracy, but there are no detailed investigations. Rapid disintegration of hookworm eggs constitutes another problem in epidemiological surveys. We studied the spatial distribution of *Schistosoma mansoni* and hookworm eggs in stool samples, the effect of homogenization, and determined egg counts over time in stool samples stored under different conditions.

Methodology

Whole-stool samples were collected from 222 individuals in a rural part of south Côte d'Ivoire. Samples were cut into four pieces and helminth egg locations from the front to the back and from the center to the surface were analyzed. Some samples were homogenized and fecal egg counts (FECs) compared before and after homogenization. The effect of stool storing methods on FECs was investigated over time, comparing stool storage on ice, covering stool samples with a water-soaked tissue, or keeping stool samples in the shade.

Principal Findings

We found no clear spatial pattern of *S. mansoni* and hookworm eggs in fecal samples. Homogenization decreased *S. mansoni* FECs ($p = 0.026$), while no effect was observed for hookworm and other soil-transmitted helminths. Hookworm FECs decreased over time. Storing stool samples on ice or covered with a moist tissue slowed down hookworm egg decay ($p<0.005$).

Conclusions/Significance

Our findings have important implications for helminth diagnosis at the individual patient level and for epidemiological surveys, anthelmintic drug efficacy studies and monitoring of control programs. Specifically, homogenization of fecal samples is recommended for an accurate detection of *S. mansoni* eggs, while keeping collected stool samples cool and moist delayed the disintegration of hookworm eggs.

Abstract

For hibernators, being born late in the active season may have important effects on growth and fattening, hence on winter survival and reproduction. This study investigated differences in growth, fattening, energetic responses, winter survival and fecundity between early-born ('EB') and late-born ('LB') juvenile garden dormice (*Eliomys quercinus*). LB juveniles grew and gained mass twice as fast as EB individuals. Torpor use was low during intensive growth, that are, first weeks of body mass gain, but increased during pre-hibernation fattening. LB juveniles showed higher torpor use, reached similar body sizes but lower fat content than EB individuals before hibernation. Finally, LB individuals showed similar patterns of hibernation, but higher proportion of breeders during the following year than EB dormice. These results suggest that torpor is incompatible with growth but promotes fattening and consolidates pre-hibernation fat depots. In garden dormice, being born late in the reproductive season is associated with a fast life history.

Tense use in Abstracts – follows same pattern as in research article

- Opening sentence mostly simple present tense when describing the current situation, or in the present perfect tense if it concerns recent trends, as in Introduction section.
- The Methods and Results sections are mostly written in the past tense (though there are also exceptions to this trend).
- The conclusions are nearly always in the present tense.
- Hedging (cautious language) used in contribution and future outlook
- In the physical sciences especially, the whole abstract could be written in the simple present tense, but in some other fields, the simple past tense is common.

Abstract Introduction: types of opening sentence

Type of sentence	Examples
General statement	1. *Coral bleaching is spreading because of rising sea temperatures.* 2. *Neglected tropical diseases are a group of 13 major disabling conditions that are among the most common chronic infections in the world's poorest people.*
Statistics	*Malaria is a major global health threat that was linked to an estimated 229 million cases of malaria and 409 000 deaths in 2019.*
Problem/Gap statement	*Despite massive research efforts, no Ebola vaccine exists to date.*
Purpose of research	*The purpose of this paper/article is… (present tense)* *The purpose of this experiment/survey/analysis…*
Researcher action	*Here, we show… / We investigated…*

How to identify (or formulate) the gap/problem statement

- **Contrast adverbials**

While / However, / Although / Though/ Nevertheless, …

- **'Quasi-negative' expressions**

X is not yet well understood

X remains somewhat unclear

- Words indicating a **lack** /dearth of research on the topic

*Few studies so far… NOT: **No** study…*

*Little is known… NOT: **Nothing** is known…*

To our knowledge…

- **Indirect questions**

It remains unclear whether… / We wanted to understand why… / Many studies have investigated if…

Referring to the research methods in the abstract

In the abstract, you don’t describe the methods in detail.

In a structured extract especially, provide a very succinct methods overview:

- Mention at least the **type of original research** (retrospective or case-control study, or systematic review, for example) and …
- **type of sample** (human patients or animals, for example), as applicable to your research.

Referring to Results, Discussion and Conclusion in the Abstract

Results:

- Summarize the principal findings/ main results of the study only.

Discussion and Conclusion:

- Explain briefly what it all means.
- Indicate limitations.
- Describe the implications/ impact/ conclusions. (Next slide)

Summarizing the main findings/conclusions & stating the expected impact/implications of the study

One or two sentences at the end of the abstract to summarize, e.g.,

- This study confirmed that…
- One of the most significant findings to emerge from this research is …..
- Notwithstanding/Despite these limitations, the study suggests that… (Summary while conceding limitations)

One sentence thereafter about the impact/implications. Don't overstate claims of the study's impact/implications.

Examples:

- This study provides new insights into…
- The findings should make a valuable contribution to the field of ….
- Characterisation of X is important for our increased understanding of …
- The findings could aid decision-making for healthcare providers..
- Characterisation of X is important for our increased understanding of …

Refer to the Academic Phrasebank for possible phrases to use.

Tips to improve cohesion and coherence

- Use *signalling words and key words*/phrases to maintain a consistent message and continuity. Examples: ‘To test this hypothesis, we…’; ‘The results indicated…’; ‘We conclude that…’

- *Express thoughts in paragraph units that correspond to one idea*. Each paragraph should have a topic statement and supporting sentences.

- *Link the Introduction to Conclusion*: in the Conclusion section, demonstrate that the ‘gap statement’ has been filled. (See example on next slide)

Example of overall text cohesion: connecting the gap/problem and the solution/conclusion in Abstracts

Background

An accurate diagnosis of helminth infection is important to improve patient management. However, there is considerable intra- and inter-specimen variation of helminth egg counts in human faeces. Homogenization of stool samples has been suggested to improve diagnostic accuracy, but there are no detailed investigations. Rapid disintegration of hookworm eggs constitutes another problem in epidemiological surveys.

…

Conclusions/Significance

Our findings have important implications for helminth diagnosis at the individual patient level and for epidemiological surveys, anthelmintic drug efficacy studies and monitoring of control programs. Specifically, homogenization of faecal samples is recommended for an accurate detection of *S. mansoni* eggs, while keeping collected stool samples cool and moist delayed the disintegration of hookworm eggs.

Abstract task

- What kind of **opening sentence** is used?
- How is the research **problem or gap** stated?
- How is the **aim/purpose** of the research stated?
- Are the **methods** described? If so, in how much detail?
- How are the **results** described?
- How are the **conclusions** and recommendations stated?
- How are the **gap/problem/aims and conclusion connected**?
- How are **tenses** used in the abstract?

Vocabulary for abstracts: see script for examples

Verbs:

- show, demonstrate, illustrate, prove, argue, examine, explore, investigate, consider, deal with, address, involve, relate to, refer to, draw on, explain, investigate, highlight, outline, provide an overview of, define, distinguish between, indicate, support, reveal, suggest, conclude, recommend

Nouns:

- intention, purpose, aim, objective, thesis, argument, issue, assumptions,
- methods, premises, results, conclusions, outcome, recommendation

Phrases used in each of the abstract sections: see script and Academic Phrasebank

Conciseness tips (make it short): examples in script

- Use **verbs** rather than too many nominalizations. (See next slide.)
- Make **shorter sentences using the subject-verb-object construction.**
- **Omit needless words** (e.g. ‘to’ rather than ‘in order to’) – see examples below and in script
- **Rewrite** sentences beginning with ‘there is’ or ‘there are’ (e.g. ***‘There are no previous studies investigating the relationship between depression and backache.’*** becomes ***‘No studies have investigated the relationship between depression and backache.’***).

For example, compare the wordy and concise paragraphs on the next slides.

Use verbs rather than nominalizations

Example of nominalized forms:

- *An interpretation of the results was done.*
- *A diagnosis of depression was made based on the findings.*

More concise and readable form with verbs:

- *We interpreted the results./The results were interpreted.*
- *We diagnosed depression. /Based on the findings, depression was diagnosed.*

Video on avoiding nominalizations:
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dNlkHtMgcPQ

Consider this example of a wordy paragraph

*As discussed, the second reaction is really the **end result** of **a very large number** of reactions. **It is also worth emphasizing that** the reactions do not represent a closed system, as r appears to be produced out of thin air. In reality, it is created from other chemical species within the cell, but we have chosen **here** not to model at such a fine level of detail. One detail not included here **that may be worth considering** is the **reversible nature** of the binding of RNAP to the promoter **region**. **It is also worth noting** that these two reactions form a simple linear chain, whereby the product of the first reaction is the reactant for the second.*

(118 words)

…..and its simpler, more concise revision:

As discussed, the second reaction is really the result of many reactions. The reactions do not represent a closed system, as r appears to be produced out of thin air. In reality, it is created from other chemical species within the cell, but we have chosen not to model at such a fine level of detail. One detail not included is the reversibility of the binding of RNAP to the promoter. These two reactions form a simple linear chain, whereby the product of the first reaction is the reactant for the second.

(Rewritten without useless words and phrases: 92 words - about 20% less reading)

Please complete the course evaluation

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Revise, revise

"In my writing, I average about ten pages a day.
 Unfortunately, they're all the same page.“

(Michael Alley, *The Craft of Scientific Writing)*

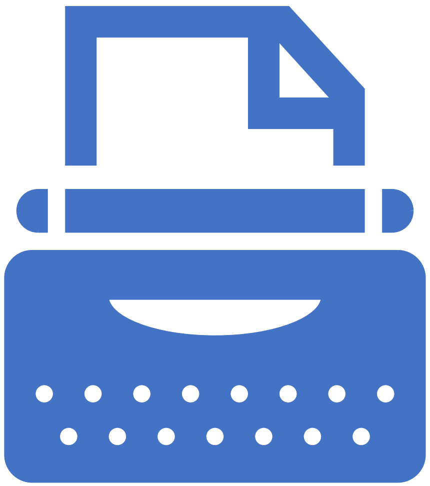
Revision is time consuming. Allow yourself more time than you think you would need. It always takes longer than you estimated.

Difference between revision, editing and proofreading

Revising, proofreading, and editing are different aspects of reviewing your writing.

- **Revising** is making structural and logical changes to your text—reformulating arguments and reordering information.
- **Editing** refers to making more local changes to things like sentence structure and phrasing to make sure your meaning is conveyed clearly and concisely.
- **Proofreading** involves looking at the text closely, line by line, to spot any typos and issues with consistency and correct them. Mistakes in grammar, vocabulary and punctuation make a bad impression and make your text difficult to read and understand.

All three stages are necessary when preparing your manuscript.



Revision includes checking...

- If you closed the research gap/solved the research problem you stated
- Argument (does it flow throughout the text?)
- Overall organization (transitions, paragraph structure, etc.)
- Evidence and analysis (do you have enough?)
- Citations and bibliography (are they complete?)

Guiding the reader

Use introductory and linking sentences and devices

Link ideas logically

Structure paragraphs coherently

Creating and enhancing overall cohesion and coherence

- Link Introduction and Conclusion sections
- Link Methods and Results
- Write introductory sentences in sections/chapters
- Include linking sentences between sections/chapters (in a thesis especially)
- Use linking devices such as conjunctions and careful repetition of key words

Some tips for revision

1. **Step away from your article/thesis**. Take a break between writing your paper and revising it. This enables you to approach your revision with fresh eyes. You'll notice more problems with clarity, argument and other errors when you've had time to step away from the paper.

2. **Read your paper aloud**, either to yourself or to someone else, is one of the best ways to check for major stylistic and structural issues. If you stumble over a sentence (or your audience looks confused), then you likely need to restructure or rephrase a sentence or paragraph. Use the read aloud function in WORD and listen to your text being read to you. There are also other options, such as Natural READER ONLINE Free Text to Speech Online with Realistic AI Voices (naturalreaders.com) , that even lets you change the accent.

3. **Ask friends, colleagues and your supervisor to read** and comment on your paper. Make use of opportunities for **peer review**.

Revising the article/thesis: more checks

- Revise macrostructure (overall cohesion and coherence) and microstructure (language use, referencing, paragraphing)
- Connect study aims and conclusions
- Link final contribution statement to gap statement in introduction (thesis and article)
- Establish links between chapter ending and next chapter (thesis)
- Link back to hypothesis / research questions in every chapter (thesis)
- Write a summary to show progression of argument through all chapters (thesis)
- Use AI/online tools to check grammar, style, etc.
- CUT! Don’t be possessive about what you have written if it’s not necessary!

Using digital tools in revision

Write first – humans remain in control

- First write yourself, then use tools to improve the writing

- LLMS such as Chat GPT provide amazing opportunities for revision, but do remember that you have to **declare them** as a source when you use them. Avoid using them to generate text – that is not currently allowed.
- There are **data privacy issues** with using LLMs – your sensitive data becomes part of the public domain and is not secure any more.
- There are local LLMs that you can download on your laptop that give you more control over your data (e.g. 7 Best LLM Tools To Run Models Locally (May 2025) - Unite.AI) There might also be issues with using them for your studies.

Using digital tools to support / revise/ improve your writing

You can benefit from a variety of free tools to support/ improve your writing, for example:

- **DeepL Write** (grammar and punctuation check, tone, rephrase entire sentences, express nuances. Good for scientific writing too) https://www.deepl.com/en/write
- **Language tool**: Free AI Grammar Checker – LanguageTool Also good as a WORD add-on. Explains mistakes.
- **Grammarly** (increasingly good at technical/scientific writing) Also gives some explanation
- **Trinka** (grammar check, tone and style enhancements, plagiarism check, good for technical/scientific writing) https://www.trinka.ai/
- **Ludwig Guru** https://ludwig.guru/ This search engine helps with grammar and style and gives contextualized examples taken from reliable sources to express an idea in different ways.

Using such tools might give you more authority when writing.

They also provide learning opportunities, to see how something can be expressed differently, acquire new vocabulary, etc.

But you need to post-edit! Read through the suggested edits carefully!

LanguageToolYour writing assistant

TRINKA

Language Tool, Trinka and ludwig.guru: Free academic grammar and style checkers

- **LanguageTool**Your writing assistant Powerful, gives explanations, also as a WORD add-on
- Ludwig.guru - Write Better English
- https://www.trinka.ai/
- Can be used as WORD Plug-in (which will probably slow down your word processing) so using the online version might be better
- Upload texts or sentences and suggestions for improvement appear: not only grammar and spelling, but also style, conciseness, etc.

reallywrite.com

Maybe you want to try an AI tool that is developed for the purpose of improving a text. Here is one possibility: https://www.reallywrite.com/

After pasting your text, you get immediate feedback about the word count, a clarity score, the longest sentence, number of complicated sentences or the use of passive voice, and more. It also gives you a word cloud of your text, showing the most frequently used words.

When don't Artificial Intelligence tools help much with scientific writing?

1. **Cohesive devices**, such as linking words (however, in addition) are often omitted or not corrected.
2. **Terminology** – smaller range: Most AI tools have a preference for everyday language rather than more formal scientific language. However, you can sometimes select the style but then the academic style might be less concise.)
3. **Vocabulary**: less variety – might use the **same words over and over** (such as 'also' in the one paragraph that will be demonstrated)
4. **Hedging** (for example 'should/might' in Discussion section) Reduced hedging, less cautious expression, e.g. might change 'could' to 'will'.
5. **Information structure**: might not conform to the 'old to new' or 'end weight' information structure that is often found in scientific writing.
6. Preference for more popular, **everyday English** expression.

So, you have to post-edit!

DeepL Write; what it can do for you

- DeepL Write is available at DeepL.com/write
- DeepL Write is a powerful tool that could help you with your writing by checking the grammar, punctuation, and style as well as providing suggestions and alternative phrasing.
- Set the style to ‘Academic’ or ‘Business’
- Paste your text into the left column and a suggested revision will appear on the right.
- If you would like to rephrase a sentence, highlight it in the text and the tool will suggest various possible revisions or rephrasing. This is very useful.
- See the examples in the paragraphs demonstrated.

DeepL Write; what it cannot do for you

- Garbage in, garbage out: if you feed a poorly written text into DeepL write, it cannot change it into a well-written text. (see demo)
- It cannot improve paragraph structure, for example when the paragraph is incoherent, does not build on the topic sentence, or ideas are not linked.
- It might make the writing flow better, also by inserting linking words, but then the same linking word might be suggested several times in one paragraph.
- Sentence fragments will not be corrected.
- It cannot correct facts.

Demonstration: DeepLWrite & Language Tool

Checklist: is my manuscript ready for submission? (Busse and August 2020)

- Did you write to a specific type of reader (readers of target journal)?
- Did you follow the introduction guide (upside-down triangle)?
- Is the research aim specific and informative?
- Have you included a thorough description of the dependent variables, the independent variables, and every covariate or descriptive variable you included in models and present in the results?
- Have you justified each of your methods, including your sampling approach, a justification of why you included each variable, your measurement approach and statistical analysis?
- Have you described your results in words that convey the direction of associations?
- Are table titles and figure legends complete?
- Does the text of the results section summarize key findings from tables and figures rather than repeating them exactly?
- Did you avoid repeating detailed results in the discussion section and avoided presenting new results in the discussion?
- Have you included limitations and implications, defending your approach where appropriate?
- Are the future steps you present specific?
- Are the research aims, methods, results and discussion are consistent in addressing the same (and all) research aims throughout?
- Is your title informative and interesting?
- Have you cited appropriately throughout the manuscript?

Writing tips 1 (Murray)

1. **Have a strategy, make a plan**
2. **Analyse writing in journals (and theses) in your field**
3. **Make an outline and fill it in**: Use verbs, for example *summarize, overview, critique, define, introduce, conclude,* etc.
4. **Get feedback from start to finish**: Discuss your ideas with colleagues, fellow students and lecturers.
5. **Set specific writing goals and sub-goals**

Writing tips 2

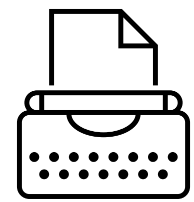
6. Write with others and set time aside to focus on writing only, without other distractions. Join a writing group, for example ‘PPHS Meet to Write’ , or start your own.

7. **Do a warm-up before you write**: Before you start writing, do a free-writing activity.

8. **Analyse reviewers’ feedback on your submission** Write a list of the actions needed and perform them.

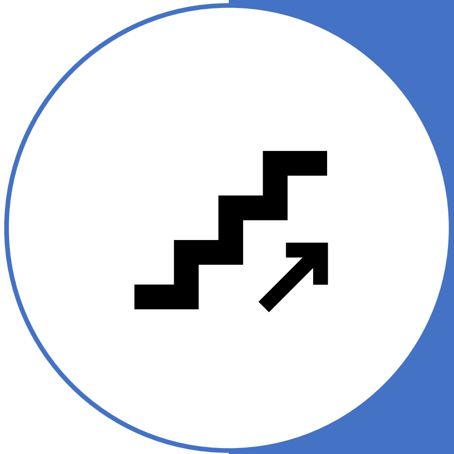
9. Be persistent, thick-skinned and resilient: Do not give up: even eminent researchers get negative comments and rejections.

10. Take care of yourself: Plan carefully. Take time to get exercise and meet up with people.



Some verbs that might be confusing

- **Rise, rose risen**: (Verb used without object): Demand for luxury goods has risen dramatically following the financial crisis.
- **raise, raised, raised** (Verb used with object): The government raised the tax rate last year.
- **arise, arose, arisen** (Verb used without object): New health problems have arisen as a result of increased mobile phone use.



Some singular and plural nouns

- Analysis (singular noun) analyses (plural noun) analyse(s)/analyze(s) (verb)
- Thesis (singular noun), theses (plural noun)
- Criterion (singular noun) criteria (plural noun)
- Datum (singular noun) data (plural noun, but increasingly used with a singular verb, as a synonym for ‘information’)
- ‘Information’ has no plural form in English (that is, ‘~~informations~~’ does not exist).
- ‘Research’ also has no plural form in English (that is, ~~‘researches’~~ does not exist). Instead, refer to ‘research projects/studies’.
- Spelling: Device (noun) and devise (verb); advise, advice

Language use: Gerund *(-ing)* and infinitive

- As subject: *Writing* is hard work.
- As object after some verbs:

  I recommend *attending* the course.
- After some prepositions:

  I look forward to *reading* your revised thesis.

Infinitive form is used after certain verbs such as advise, require, need, etc.

Study the explanations and do the exercises at the end of the script for this lesson.

List uploaded on ADAM.

Use of ‘this’ and ‘it’

These common, useful pronouns can cause confusion when the antecedent is not clear. In informal English, they are used more loosely. For clarity, avoid using them on their own in scientific English..

Example: ‘Free information about cancer treatment. To get it, phone 0800...’

To get what? Cancer treatment or information?

Rather use ‘This / Such’ with a noun in academic writing, eg. ‘Such information can be obtained by calling....’, or in plain English, ‘To get such/this information, phone...’

The use of ‘which’ and ‘what’ in questions

- Use ‘which’ when the choice is between two or only a few things, for example

  ‘Which method did you use, A or B?’

- Use ‘what’ when referring to many possibilities, e.g.

  ‘What career did you decide to follow?’

Portfolio

- Remember that, in order to earn the 2 credits for the course, you need to submit a portfolio consisting of:

1. ONE file in WORD format, containing
2. the **first, unreviewed version** of each assignment
3. followed by the **final improved version**
4. of each of the **FOUR reviewed assignments.**

- The portfolio text should contain **no comments or markup**, apart from indicating the **moves or sections**. (Also no feedback grids)
- Focus on improving the texts according to my comments and those of your reviewers.
- Name the portfolio surname.name Portfolio

Assignment 6B: Reviewed assignment (Abstract)

Choice between 6A Discussion/Conclusion and 6B Abstract . Could do both but one is reviewed.

Assignment 6B: Abstract

- Write an Abstract for a research article based on your research, or for a proposal. Include the various sections, writing cohesively and concisely. Word limit: 150-250 words.

- Follow the review process.

- You could do both Assignments 6A and 6B, but your reviewer only needs to review one of them. If the two of you agree to it, you could also review both assignments. The teacher only comments on one assignment. In the manuscript clinics you could ask questions on these or any other texts.

Name the text as follows: 6BSurname.Name first version

Thank you
for your attention.
Great success and all the best for
your research and writing!